

Word family: **frank / frankly / frankness**

Base word: frank

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**

Related forms:

- * **frank** (adj.) — 坦率的；直率的；坦白的
- * **frankly** (adv.) — 坦率地；老實說；說真的
- * **frankness** (n.) — 坦率；直率；坦白
- * **to be frank** — 坦白說
- * **frank discussion** — 坦率的討論
- * **frank admission** — 坦白承認
- * **frank assessment** — 坦率而直接的評估
- * **frank exchange of views** — 坦誠交換意見

Meaning in this passage

> ...it made me more stable, more disciplined, and **frankly**, much happier.

Here, **frankly** is a discourse adverb.

It means:

to be honest; speaking openly about what I really think — 老實說；說真的；坦白說

The speaker is not describing *how* they became happier. Instead, **frankly** comments on the whole statement that follows:

> **frankly, much happier**

> = **老實說，快樂得多**

中文翻譯：

它也令我變得更穩定、更自律，而且**說真的 / 老實說**，也快樂得多。

So here:

frankly = 用來表明接下來的話是說話者坦率、真實的看法

1. **frank** (坦率的；直率的) — 坦率的；坦白的

This is the core adjective sense.

Practice 1

> She was very **frank** about her mistakes.

她很**坦率地**談自己的錯誤。

Practice 2

> I appreciate your **frank** answer.

我欣賞你**坦率**的回答。

Practice 3

> We had a **frank conversation** about the problem.

我們就問題進行了一次**坦誠的對話**。

MCQ-ready definition:

frank = 願意直接而誠實地表達真實想法，不刻意掩飾

2. **be frank with someone** — 對某人坦白

Practice 1

> I'll **be frank with you**.

我會**坦白**跟你說。

Practice 2

> She was **frank with her manager** about the difficulties.

她向經理**坦白**說明困難。

MCQ-ready definition:

be frank with someone = 對某人直接說出自己真正的想法或事實

3. **be frank about something** — 坦率談論某事

Practice 1

> He was **frank** about his lack of experience.

他很**坦率地承認**自己經驗不足。

Practice 2

> We need to be **frank** about the risks.

我們需要**坦白面對**這些風險。

MCQ-ready definition:

be frank about X = 不掩飾地直接談論 X

4. **frank discussion / conversation — 坦率討論；坦誠對話**

Practice 1

> They had a **frank discussion** about what went wrong.

他們就出了甚麼問題進行了**坦率討論**。

Practice 2

> A **frank conversation** helped clear the air.

一場**坦誠的對話**有助化解不快。

MCQ-ready definition:

frank discussion = 雙方直接而誠實地交換真實看法的討論

5. **frank admission — 坦白承認**

Practice 1

> His **frank admission** surprised everyone.

他的**坦白承認**令大家感到意外。

Practice 2

> The interview included a **frank admission of failure**.

訪問中包括對失敗的**坦白承認**。

MCQ-ready definition:

frank admission = 不掩飾地承認某個通常令人尷尬或不利的事實

6. **frank assessment** — 坦率評估；直言不諱的評估

Practice 1

> The report gives a **frank assessment** of the situation.

報告對情況作出**坦率而直接的評估**。

Practice 2

> She gave me a **frank assessment** of my performance.

她對我的表現作出了**坦誠的評價**。

MCQ-ready definition:

frank assessment = 不粉飾、不迴避問題的直接評估

7. **frank exchange of views** — 坦誠交換意見

A formal collocation.

Practice 1

> The meeting involved a **frank exchange of views**.

會議中雙方**坦誠交換了意見**。

Practice 2

> They had a **frank exchange** about the disagreement.

他們就分歧進行了**坦率交流**。

MCQ-ready definition:

frank exchange of views = 各方直接而誠實地表達不同觀點

8. **frankly** (坦率地 ; 老實說) — 坦率地 ; 老實說

This is the exact form used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> It made me more disciplined and, **frankly**, much happier.

它令我更自律，而且**老實說**，也快樂得多。

Practice 2

> **Frankly**, I think we need a better system.

坦白說，我覺得我們需要一套更好的系統。

Practice 3

> **Frankly**, I was disappointed.

老實說，我很失望。

MCQ-ready definition:

frankly = 用來表示接下來是說話者直接而真誠的看法

9. **to be frank** — 坦白說

Very common discourse marker.

Practice 1

> **To be frank**, I expected a better result.

坦白說，我原本期待更好的結果。

Practice 2

> **To be frank**, the plan is too complicated.

說真的，這個方案太複雜。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****to be frank = 用來引出直接、坦白，可能不太客氣的真實意見****

10. ****quite frankly — 坦白講；說真的****

A stronger version.

Practice 1

> ****Quite frankly****, I don't agree.

****坦白講****，我不同意。

Practice 2

> The delay was, ****quite frankly****, unacceptable.

那次延誤，****老實說****，是不能接受的。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****quite frankly = 更強烈地表示接下來的話很直接、坦白****

11. ****frankly speaking — 坦白說****

Possible, though ****frankly**** or ****to be frank**** is often more natural.

Practice 1

> ****Frankly speaking****, I found the task confusing.

****坦白說****，我覺得這項任務很混亂。

Practice 2

> ****Frankly speaking****, we were not ready.

****老實說****，我們當時還沒有準備好。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****frankly speaking = 直接說出真實看法****

12. **frankly** (直率地做 / 說) — 坦率地

This is the more literal manner-adverb use.

Practice 1

> She spoke **frankly** about her concerns.

她**坦率地**談自己的憂慮。

Practice 2

> He answered **frankly**.

他**坦白地**回答。

MCQ-ready definition:

frankly = 以直接、誠實、不掩飾的方式說話

13. **frankness** — 坦率；直率

Practice 1

> I appreciated her **frankness**.

我很欣賞她的**坦率**。

Practice 2

> His **frankness** made the conversation easier.

他的**坦誠**令談話更容易進行。

MCQ-ready definition:

frankness = 願意直接而真誠表達想法的特質

14. **refreshing frankness** — 令人耳目一新的坦率

Practice 1

> She spoke with **refreshing frankness**.

她說話非常坦率，令人覺得**難得真誠**。

Practice 2

> His **frankness** was refreshing.

他的**坦率**令人耳目一新。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****refreshing frankness = 因少見的直接和真誠而令人欣賞的坦率****

Important distinction 1: **frank vs honest**

These overlap, but are not identical.

****honest****

tells the truth; does not deceive.

****frank****

speaks openly and directly, even when the truth may be uncomfortable.

> honest person

> 誠實的人

> frank discussion

> 坦率直接的討論

A person can be honest without being especially frank if they simply avoid discussing sensitive topics.

Important distinction 2: **frank vs direct**

****direct****

gets straight to the point.

****frank****

adds the idea of openness and honesty.

> direct instruction

> 直接指示

> frank admission

> 坦白承認

****Direct**** does not necessarily imply personal honesty.

Important distinction 3: ****frank vs blunt****

Very important.

****frank****

open and honest, often neutral or positive.

****blunt****

very direct, sometimes too direct or insensitive.

> frank feedback

> 坦率回饋

> blunt criticism

> 直截了當得可能有點傷人的批評

So ****frank**** is not automatically rude.

Important distinction 4: ****frank vs outspoken****

****frank****

open about what one thinks in a particular conversation.

****outspoken****

habitually willing to express strong or controversial views publicly.

> frank answer

> 坦白回答

> outspoken critic

> 敢言的批評者

Important distinction 5: **frank vs open**

open

broadly willing to share thoughts or information.

frank

specifically direct and honest about potentially uncomfortable truths.

> open discussion

> 開放討論

> frank discussion

> 坦率而不迴避問題的討論

Important distinction 6: **frankly vs honestly**

In discourse markers:

> **Frankly, ...**

> **Honestly, ...**

can both mean **老實說**.

But **frankly** often sounds a little more formal and may signal that the speaker is about to say something direct or potentially uncomfortable.

Important distinction 7: **frankly vs seriously**

frankly

marks honesty/directness.

seriously

can mark seriousness or emphasis.

> Frankly, I disagree.

> 坦白說，我不同意。

> Seriously, I disagree.

> 我是認真的，我不同意。

Different pragmatic functions.

Important distinction 8: **frankly vs actually**

frankly

= here's my honest/direct opinion.

actually

= in fact / contrary to expectation.

> Frankly, I'm tired.

> 老實說，我累了。

> Actually, I'm tired.

> 其實，我累了。

Subtle but very different.

Important distinction 9: **frankly can modify the whole sentence**

In your passage:

> ...and **frankly**, much happier.

It does not mean:

> "I became happier in a frank way." ❌

Instead, it means:

"To be honest, I became much happier."

So this is a **sentence/discourse adverb**, not a normal manner adverb.

Important distinction 10: **frankly can sound strong**

Compare:

> I don't think this will work.

> 我覺得這未必可行。

> Frankly, I don't think this will work.

> 坦白說，我覺得這行不通。

Adding **frankly** can make the statement sound more direct and forceful.

Important distinction 11: **to be frank vs if I'm honest**

They overlap strongly.

to be frank

slightly more formal/direct.

if I'm honest

more conversational and often softer.

Both can translate naturally as:

老實說 / 坦白說

Important distinction 12: **frankness vs honesty**

honesty

truthfulness in behaviour and speech.

frankness

openness and directness in expression.

Someone might be honest but reserved, so they have honesty without much frankness.

Family-extension note

The **frank** family is not massively polysemous, but it has an important split between:

1. **personal communication style**

- * frank person
- * frank discussion
- * frank assessment

2. **manner of speaking**

- * speak frankly
- * answer frankly

3. **sentence-level discourse marker**

- * frankly, ...
- * quite frankly
- * to be frank

4. **quality noun**

- * frankness

For your passage, the exact branch is:

frankly = a discourse marker meaning “to be honest / speaking openly”

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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frank	坦率的；直率的	open and honest
be frank with someone	對某人坦白	direct with person
be frank about X	坦率談 X	open about topic
frank discussion	坦率討論	honest exchange
frank admission	坦白承認	admit openly
frank assessment	坦率評估	no sugar-coating
frank exchange	坦誠交流	open views
frankly (discourse)	老實說；坦白說	honest opinion

frankly (manner)	坦率地	manner of speaking
to be frank	坦白說	discourse marker
quite frankly	坦白講	stronger marker
frankly speaking	坦白說	direct statement
frankness	坦率；直率	quality

For your original sentence

> Overall, this was a positive change because it did not just make me more efficient; it made me more stable, more disciplined, and **frankly**, much happier.

Here:

frankly = 說話者插入一句「老實說 / 說真的」，強調「我真的比以前快樂得多」是自己的真實感受

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 總結來說，這是一個正面的改變，因為它不只是令我做事更有效率；它也令我變得更穩定、更自律，而且**說真的**，也快樂得多。

The cleanest contrast is:

> **honestly** = 誠實地 / 老實說

> **frankly** = 坦白直接地說，尤其可能引出較強烈或不加修飾的真實看法

> **bluntly** = 直截了當地，甚至可能有點不顧感受

For this passage, **frankly** is best understood as a **sentence-level aside**: “to be honest.”